

October 6, 2026

Channel: Tim Luong · Published: Oct 06, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/shorts/usmaeucEGF8> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Tim Luong shares a cautionary hiring story: a sales employee who lied his way into the job took 5 months to remove despite gut instincts flagging him at 30 days — the core lesson being to trust your intuition early.

Contents

- 🙄 The Lying Sales Hire
- ⌚ Ignoring the Gut Feeling
- 💡 Key Takeaway: Trust Your Instincts

🙄 The Lying Sales Hire 0:00

- Tim describes this person as the biggest liar he has ever encountered in his entire life
- The hire came from a rival/competitor company operating in the same market
 - Made very large, impressive claims during the hiring process
 - Specifically boasted about having grown a company's revenue to nine figures
- Tim acknowledges being genuinely deceived, saying the person deserves "credit" for how convincingly they lied
- Salespeople, Tim notes, are inherently persuasive by profession
 - "They're not in sales for nothing" — they can easily talk you into hiring them
 - This makes vetting sales candidates especially difficult and requires extra vigilance

⌚ Ignoring the Gut Feeling 0:21

- Just **30 days** into the hire, Tim's instincts told him something was wrong
- He consulted a trusted person inside the company, asking directly: "Should I let this person go?"
 - The collective reasoning was: "It's only been 30 days — maybe he's still adjusting"
 - They decided to wait and see the full picture before acting
- Despite that early internal alarm, Tim did not remove the employee until nearly **5 months** later
 - This delay is framed as a costly mistake — both in time and business impact

💡 Key Takeaway: Trust Your Instincts 0:41

- Tim reflects that every bad hire he has made in business shared the same pattern
 - His gut knew the truth early — he consistently waited 30, 60, or 90 extra days to act
- Core advice for hiring salespeople specifically: be smart and analytical, because salespeople are skilled at convincing you to hire them
- But equally important: **trust your gut** — don't let a smooth interview override internal warning signals

"If I had trusted my gut from the start, it would have never led me down the wrong path."

- The implicit framework he advocates:
 - Notice the internal signal early (even at day 30)
 - Do not rationalize it away with "give them more time"
 - Act decisively rather than deferring for months